

“MY NEVER AGAIN LIST”

TEXT: Hebrews 3:1-19 “Wherefore, holy brethren, partakers of the heavenly calling, consider the Apostle and High Priest of our profession, Christ Jesus; ²Who was faithful to him that appointed him, as also Moses was faithful in all his house. ³For this *man* was counted worthy of more glory than Moses, inasmuch as he who hath builded the house hath more honour than the house. ⁴For every house is builded by some *man*; but he that built all things is God. ⁵And Moses verily was faithful in all his house, as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were to be spoken after; ⁶But Christ as a son over his own house; whose house are we, if we hold fast the confidence and the rejoicing of the hope firm unto the end. ⁷Wherefore (as the Holy Ghost saith, To day if ye will hear his voice, ⁸Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness: ⁹When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my works forty years. ¹⁰Wherefore I was grieved with that generation, and said, They do alway err in their heart; and they have not known my ways. ¹¹So I swore in my wrath, They shall not enter into my rest.) ¹²Take heed, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief, in departing from the living God. ¹³But exhort one another daily, while it is called To day; lest any of you be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin. ¹⁴For we are made partakers of Christ, if we hold the beginning of our confidence stedfast unto the end; ¹⁵While it is said, To day if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts, as in the provocation. ¹⁶For some, when they had heard, did provoke: howbeit not all that came out of Egypt by Moses. ¹⁷But with whom was he grieved forty years? was it not with them that had sinned, whose carcasses fell in the wilderness? ¹⁸And to whom swore he that they should not enter into his rest, but to them that believed not? ¹⁹So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief.”

INTRO: A couple of months ago Elaine Looney came to me with a piece of notebook paper that was handwritten, both front and back. She very politely asked me as she and Hugh’s pastor, to please pray these Scriptures over Hugh until Easter. When I

first looked at the list I did not think too much about it, but as I began to pray that list over Hugh day in and day out, it began to get down in my spirit. So I asked Elaine for her permission to preach a series of sermons from that list. I have entitled this sermon, **“MY NEVER AGAIN LIST”**.

There are some things in life that after we have done them, we realize they did not go over well, and we say to ourselves, **“I WILL NEVER AGAIN** allow myself to do that particular thing!” The reason we do this is, we do not want to be guilty of repeating the same old mistakes over and over again! (ILL: Sermons, things said to family or business associates, decisions concerning employment, etc..)

I think that it would serve us all very well as we go through life, to make ourselves a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**!

Israel would have been light years ahead if they would have maintained a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**! They just kept repeating the same old mistakes over and over again! They found themselves in a vicious cycle of failure! **Hebrews 3:8-11** **“Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness: ⁹When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my works forty years. ¹⁰Wherefore I was grieved with that generation, and said, They do alway err in their heart; and they have not known my ways. ¹¹So I swear in my wrath, They shall not enter into my rest.”**

Does that sound like anyone you know? Sad to say, but I can see myself in that mode, during many periods of my life!

Look at what the word of God say’s about repeating the same mistakes, over and over again; Solomon said, **Proverbs 21:16** **“The man that wandereth out of the way of understanding shall remain in the congregation of the dead.”**

Proverbs 27:8 **“As a bird that wandereth from her nest, so is a man that wandereth from his place.”**

The Apostle Peter spoke some of the most severe words in Scripture on the subject of making the same mistakes over and over again, when he said, [2 Peter 2:14-22](#) “Having eyes full of adultery, and that cannot cease from sin; beguiling unstable souls: an heart they have exercised with covetous practices; cursed children: ¹⁵Which have forsaken the right way, and are gone astray, following the way of Balaam *the son* of Bosor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness; ¹⁶But was rebuked for his iniquity: the dumb ass speaking with man's voice forbad the madness of the prophet. ¹⁷These are wells without water, clouds that are carried with a tempest; to whom the mist of darkness is reserved for ever. ¹⁸For when they speak great swelling *words* of vanity, they allure through the lusts of the flesh, through much wantonness, those that were clean escaped from them who live in error. ¹⁹While they promise them liberty, they themselves are the servants of corruption: for of whom a man is overcome, of the same is he brought in bondage. ²⁰For if after they have escaped the pollutions of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, they are again entangled therein, and overcome, the latter end is worse with them than the beginning. ²¹For it had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered unto them. ²²But it is happened unto them according to the true proverb, The dog is turned to his own vomit again; and the sow that was washed to her wallowing in the mire.”

For that reason it becomes imperative that I make myself a “NEVER AGAIN LIST”! Whether I write it out on notebook paper, put it on the screen of my computer, or make a mental note of it, I know that I must do it in order to maintain a victorious life!

Again, the Apostle Peter writes, [1 Peter 2:24-25](#) “Who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree, that we, being dead to sins, should live unto righteousness: by whose stripes ye were healed. ²⁵For ye were as sheep going

astray; but are now returned unto the Shepherd and Bishop of your souls.”

I am going to list for you some things that I have incorporated into “MY NEVER AGAIN LIST”;

I. NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS CONDEMNATION FOR...

A. Romans 8:1-14 “*There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit. ²For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death. ³For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh: ⁴That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit. ⁵For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh; but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit. ⁶For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace. ⁷Because the carnal mind is enmity against God: for it is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be. ⁸So then they that are in the flesh cannot please God. ⁹But ye are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you. Now if any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of his. ¹⁰And if Christ be in you, the body is dead because of sin; but the Spirit is life because of righteousness. ¹¹But if the Spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you, he that raised up Christ from the dead shall also quicken your mortal bodies by his Spirit that dwelleth in you. ¹²Therefore, brethren, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live after the flesh. ¹³For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die: but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live. ¹⁴For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God.”*

The Greek word for “CONDEMNATION” here is “KATAKRIMA” (Kat- ak- ree-ma), meaning, an adverse sentence.

To be **“CONDEMNED”**, means that after all evidence has been considered, to be declared to be reprehensible, wrong, or evil. It means that we have been pronounced guilty!

B. Please take a moment to remember, before you and I found Jesus as Lord and Saviour, we had a **“CONDEMNED”** sign hanging around our necks!

Absolutely all the evidence pointed to the fact that we were reprehensible, wrong, evil, guilty, therefore we were **“CONDEMNED”** by the power of sin.

According to the writer of the book of Romans, because I am in Christ, I am now free from **“CONDEMNATION”**!

Can you imagine the Joy a person would experience if they had been **“CONDEMNED”** to death for a hideous crime, and in the process of being strapped into the electric chair, the Governor walked into the death chamber with proper documentation to prove a pardon from their **“CONDEMNATION”**? They would no doubt make a complete fool out of themselves, before the Governor, their families and friends, a national television audience, and anyone else who was inclined to watch!

Well, I have even better news than that! Every person in this place who knows Jesus in the full and free pardon of sin has been freed from the guilt, and the power of **“CONDEMNATION”**!

SONG: I’m not super lucky, I’m in this by design, Salvation for my soul, was God’s idea not mine, so a Lamb was slain and blood was spilled, before the world’s were framed, to purchase my salvation, and curse sins guilt and shame.

And I’ve been blood bought, I’ve been mercy sought, when I

stumbled in the arms of love, I was caught, I've been hell fought, but I've been truth taught, and I know that I can make it cause I'm blood bought.

Three men hung on crosses, upon Mt. Calvary, one chose condemnation, and one chose clemency, but on the middle cross with a crown of thorns, hung the hope of liberty, when He cried it is finished, that debt was paid for me.

John 3:16-18 "For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. ¹⁷For God sent not his Son into the world to condemn the world; but that the world through him might be saved.

¹⁸He that believeth on him is not condemned: but he that believeth not is condemned already, because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God."

John 5:24 "Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life."

C. Even though we are all aware that a Christian is not supposed to live in "CONDEMNATION", we are also aware that Satan is "AN ACCUSER OF THE BRETHREN"! **Rev. 12:10-11** "And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of his Christ: for the accuser of our brethren is cast down, which accused them before our God day and night. ¹¹And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb, and by the word of their testimony; and they loved not their lives unto the death."

First of all, the enemy "ACCUSES" you to God! This is not anything new, he has been doing this since the beginning of

time!

Job is a good example of how the enemy of our souls “**ACCUSES**” us before God! **Job 1:1, 6-11** “There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name *was* Job; and that man was perfect and upright, and one that feared God, and eschewed evil.⁶ Now there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the Lord, and Satan came also among them.⁷ And the Lord said unto Satan, Whence comest thou? Then Satan answered the Lord, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.⁸ And the Lord said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant Job, that *there is* none like him in the earth, a perfect and an upright man, one that feareth God, and escheweth evil?⁹ Then Satan answered the Lord, and said, Doth Job fear God for nought? ¹⁰Hast not thou made an hedge about him, and about his house, and about all that he hath on every side? thou hast blessed the work of his hands, and his substance is increased in the land. ¹¹But put forth thine hand now, and touch all that he hath, and he will curse thee to thy face.”

Look at this, there is not one shred of evidence to support anything that the Devil is saying about Job!

Job has a proven track record, but that does not keep the enemy from “**ACCUSING**” Job to God! Can you imagine that? God knows Job to be a man of impeccable integrity, Satan is aware of Job’s integrity as well, yet it does not deter the enemy from “**ACCUSING**” Job!

So you can see that the truth has nothing to do with the enemy attempting to “**CONDEMN**” Job, or anyone else!
(Story of Martin Luther)

This tactic of the enemy has never worked and will never work because when God looks at us he sees us through the shed blood of Jesus! Glory to God I am as **RIGHTEOUS** as the blood of Jesus can make me, and there is absolutely nothing the

devil can do about it!

Secondly, the enemy **“ACCUSES”** us to ourselves! This is possibly one of his most effective weapons he has in his arsenal!

It is difficult for us to forgive ourselves! We can usually forgive someone else quicker than we can forgive ourselves!

You see, once God forgives you it is vitally important that you learn to forgive yourself!

If you cannot bring yourself to the position of accepting and appropriating forgiveness in your own life, you will always live under a cloud of self **“CONDEMNATION”**!

You see, the reason it is so vitally important to the strategy of the enemy for us, as the children of God to fail to forgive ourselves, is because as long as we live in self **“CONDEMNATION”** we cannot accept and appropriate the benefits of God in our lives!

Thirdly, an equally effective tool of the enemy is Satan’s ability to manipulate well meaning **“CHRISTIANS”** to **“CONDEMN”** one another!

Jesus said that the world would know that **“We have passed from death unto life, because we love our brother”**!

If I love you, I can not bring myself to aid in the process of hanging the old **“CONDEMNED”** sign, that God so powerfully delivered you from, back around your neck again!

When I do that, I have become the devils helper!

The bottom line is, that I refuse to allow the devil, myself, or

anyone else, to bring me under “**CONDEMNATION**” ever again because, “*There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.*”

II. NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS I CAN'T, FOR... A.

Philip. 4:13 “I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.”

The Bible makes aware that “the power of life and death is in the tongue.” Proverbs 18:21

Because of that you need “**A NEVER AGAIN LIST**”!

I am fully aware that over the past couple of decades or so that some folks have taken the doctrine of positive confession to an extreme.

However some of us have allowed people who are inclined to operate at the extremes, to drive us all the way to the opposite end of the spectrum, almost without our being aware of it!

In fact, the “**name it, and claim it, blab it and grab it**” crowd has caused some of us to become a part of the “**doubt it, and do without it**” crowd!

Please understand, I was raised in a very conservative Pentecostal environment. If you had mentioned the word “**charismatic**” around my parents they would have reacted in one of three ways; prayed for your healing, found some home remedy for it, or rubbed some leniment on it!

Even though I was raised in such a conservative environment, my parents knew enough about faith and the Word of God that they would not allow “**negative confession**” in their home! (I have seen my father lay hands on a pickup truck and pray for it!)

I can remember many times that I would tell my father that **“I CAN’T”** and he would say to me, **“CAN’T NEVER DID ANYTHING, AND WEIGHT IS WHAT BROKE THE BRIDGE DOWN , BOY”!**

I suppose that early training is what has caused me to believe that **“I CAN”**, if I will it, and God will help me with it!

There is a computer term, **“G-I-G-O”**, that means **“GARBAGE IN, GARBAGE OUT”!**

There is a lot of truth to that, Nutritionists will tell you, you are what you eat. By the same token the Bible say’s you will become what you say!

B. I want us to take a few minutes to carefully examine our text in it’s overall setting.

Paul is writing to the Philippian church here. This Church could be considered the **“ideal”** church, in many ways. Scripture makes aware that this church was very appreciative and benevolent. Do you think they had a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**?

This church was the fruit of Paul’s second missionary journey. The founding of this church certainly would not have caused the pastor to be invited to speak at a church growth seminar, because it’s beginnings were meager and down right small.

The nucleus of the charter membership of First Assembly of God in Philippi were a few women at the river side. Now that doesn’t sound like much of an up and coming church, does it?

The first convert of this church was also a woman, by the name of Lydia, and her occupation was a seller of purple.

Following Lydia's conversion the Philippian jailer and his family became a part of this struggling home missions work.

This church was founded amidst some very bitter persecution, in fact, the Philippian jailer was saved while he was tending the jail cell of the pastor and the associate pastor!

Paul and Silas were such upbeat people that at midnight they forgot they were in prison, and held a prayer and praise fest that caused the jail house to rock, and in the midst of a suicide attempt the Philippian jailer got saved!

Is it possible that Paul and Silas maintained a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**?

When I was growing up we used to sing a song entitled **“Prayer Bells of heaven”**, and it goes something like this:
**“When Paul and Silas both were thrown in jail,
they did not worry who would go their bail,
but on the Prayer Bells they began to ring,
off fell their stocks and they began to sing;**

**Prayer Bells of heaven oh how sweetly they ring,
bearing the message unto Jesus the King,
when you are burdened down with troubles and care,
ring on and on for God will answer your prayer.**

**Three Hebrew children to the flames were thrown,
because the mortal King they would not own,
Jesus delivered, and the King then saw,
Prayer Bells of heaven beats a man made law.**

**Into the garden Jesus went to pray,
until his sweat became as blood they say,
ringing the Prayer Bells there in agony,**

bringing Salvation that we might be free.”

In all actuality, the book of Philippians is a love letter from Paul to these wonderful people!

This love letter to the Philippian church was written during some very difficult and trying times, it was written from a jail cell!

With the backdrop of the scripture setting in mind, as you read through this book, you become increasingly aware of the outbursts of affection, gratitude, joy, and victory that come out of the most difficult of circumstances!

Philip. 4:10-13 “I rejoice greatly in the Lord that at last you have renewed your concern for me. Indeed, you have been concerned, but you had no opportunity to show it.¹¹ I am not saying this because I am in need, for I have learned to be content whatever the circumstances.¹² I know what it is to be in need, and I know what it is to have plenty. I have learned the secret of being content in any and every situation, whether well fed or hungry, whether living in plenty or in want.” **NOTICE THIS: OUT OF THE MOST DIFFICULT OF CIRCUMSTANCES COMES THE STATEMENT, “¹³I can do everything through him who gives me strength.”**

C. So great was the positive influence in my life in my formative years that I have lived life believing that “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.”

The first verse I had either one of my children commit to memory was Philippians 4:13! Why? Because I wanted them to know throughout life that no matter what they were facing that they **“COULD DO ALL THINGS THROUGH CHRIST WHICH GAVE THEM STRENGTH”!!!**

After I was sure that they had committed the verse to memory we would quote it like this: **“I WILL DO ALL THINGS THROUGH CHRIST WHO GIVES ME STRENGTH”!!!**

I am here to tell you tonight, that no matter what you are facing, you can make it **“THROUGH CHRIST”!** (Story of little train who thought he could!)

Make yourself a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”** and on that list promise yourself that **“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS I CAN’T, FOR I CAN DO ALL THINGS THROUGH CHRIST WHO GIVES ME STRENGTH”!!!**

Romans 14:1-4 “Accept him whose faith is weak, without passing judgment on disputable matters. ²One man's faith allows him to eat everything, but another man, whose faith is weak, eats only vegetables. ³The man who eats everything must not look down on him who does not, and the man who does not eat everything must not condemn the man who does, for God has accepted him. ⁴Who are you to judge someone else's servant? To his own master he stands or falls. And he will stand, for the Lord is able to make him stand.”

Luke 10:19 “Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.”

Isaiah 40:31 “But they that wait upon the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; *and* they shall walk, and not faint.”

1 Tim. 1:12 “And I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who hath enabled me (Given me strength), for that he counted me faithful, putting me into the ministry;”

Go ahead, make yourself a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**, and on that list promise yourself, **“NEVER AGAIN WILL I**

CONFESS I CAN'T, FOR I CAN DO ALL THINGS THROUGH CHRIST WHO GIVES ME STRENGTH"!

III. NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR...

A. Philip. 4:19 "But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus."

Last week we talked about the meager beginnings of this Church at Philippi, which amounted to a few women at the rivers edge. We also spoke of the bitter persecution and most trying of times that seemed to stalk this **"IDEAL"** Church!

Now, the billing of this Church as an **"IDEAL"** Church is not my idea, but the Apostle Paul's. Paul sets this Church up as a **"ROLE MODEL"** for others to follow.

Some people say **"I don't want anyone to follow me because I am human"**! Paul said **"Follow me as I follow Christ"**!

I have found that **"ROLE MODELS"** whether people or institutions, normally surface through bitterly difficult circumstances!

Everyone wants to preach like Paul, sing like Silas, and have compassion like Jesus, but who among us is willing to endure what they did to become a **"ROLE MODEL"**?

Notice the train of thought Paul followed when writing to the **"IDEAL"** Church;

1) In chapter One he thanks God for this Church! And also for their fellowship with him and his Ministry! He goes to great length to explain to them that the persecution that he, and they were experiencing was for the furtherance of the Gospel! He wraps up chapter One by saying, **"DON'T BE TERRIFIED BY YOUR ADVERSARIES"**!

2) In chapter Two he admonishes this Church, that no matter what they faced to **“WALK IN LOVE”**! He tells them not to fall into the trap of covetousness, and to allow the mind of Christ to always be present in them in every situation. He tells them not to murmur or get involved in disputes between one another, but to keep their focus so that their light would shine in the midst of a crooked and perverse generation!

3) He begins chapter three by telling them to rejoice in the Lord! Imagine that! In the midst of bitter persecution they are being told to rejoice! (Paul told the men who were about to be drowned in a storm at sea to “be of good cheer”!)

He tells them to be on the lookout for the enemy by saying, **Philip. 3:2** “Watch out for those dogs, those men who do evil, those mutilators of the flesh.”

He also tells them to put no confidence in the flesh. He say’s that those who put confidence in the flesh will wind up disappointed! Then notice what he say’s, **Philip. 3:8-14** “Yea doubtless, and I count all things *but* loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Christ Jesus my Lord: for whom I have suffered the loss of all things, and do count them *but* dung, that I may win Christ, ⁹And be found in him, not having mine own righteousness, which is of the law, but that which is through the faith of Christ, the righteousness which is of God by faith: ¹⁰That I may know him, and the power of his resurrection, and the fellowship of his sufferings, being made conformable unto his death; ¹¹If by any means I might attain unto the resurrection of the dead. ¹²Not as though I had already attained, either were already perfect: but I follow after, if that I may apprehend that for which also I am apprehended of Christ Jesus. ¹³Brethren, I count not myself to have apprehended: but *this* one thing *I do*, forgetting those things which are behind, and reaching forth unto those things which are before, ¹⁴I press toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus.”

4) Paul begins chapter four by identifying the Philippian church as **“TRUE YOKEFELLOWS”** in the great cause of the Gospel.

Paul spends most of Chapter Four reminiscing about how the Philippian Church had ministered to his need throughout the entirety of his ministry.

In verse Eighteen Paul says, “I have received full payment and even more; I am amply supplied, now that I have received from Epaphroditus the gifts you sent. They are a fragrant offering, an acceptable sacrifice, pleasing to God.”

In spite of their difficult circumstances the Church at Philippi found a way to demonstrate the love of Christ to Paul through their benevolent spirit.

Paul was offering his commendation to them for their random acts of kindness toward him.

Realizing he did not have the wherewithal to return their generosity Paul says, “But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

Please understand Paul is saying, **“THANK YOU FOR YOUR GENEROSITY TOWARD ME. I HAVE NO WAY TO REPAY YOU, BUT MY GOD SHALL SUPPLY ALL YOUR NEED ACCORDING TO HIS RICHES IN GLORY BY CHRIST JESUS”!**

This guarantee from Paul to the Philippians is much better than a personal guarantee! He is saying **“I GUARANTEE YOU THAT GOD WILL SUPPLY ALL YOUR NEED, HEAVEN HAS BEEN PUT UP AS COLLATERAL!”**

B. It seems that in our day and time people have become so accustomed to having things handed to them on a silver platter that we have come to expect **“EASY STREET”** in every arena of our lives! (Clothes, transportation, education, comfortable home, business, etc...)

This **“EASY STREET”** mentality has led to a lack of commitment to certain tasks. (Job, marriage, family, finances, etc...)

Lack of commitment to certain tasks has led to negative confession regarding needs that we have.

Far too many Christians are **“CONFESSING LACK”** over their lives!

C. I am in the process of formulating a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**, and one of the things I have listed is, **“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... God shall supply all my need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”**

God has put Heaven up as collateral against my need being supplied!

Paul couldn't even supply his own need, how could he go out on such a limb to guarantee this Philippian Church that God would thoroughly minister to their every need?

1) He knew God had been faithful to Israel throughout their scenic tour of the wilderness! He led them by a cloud in the day, and a pillar of fire at night! He provided manna for them to eat, and water for them to drink! (It mattered little whether it came from a rock, or a tree turned bitter water sweet.)

Deut. 2:7 “The Lord your God has blessed you in all the work of your hands. He has watched over your journey through this vast desert. These forty years the Lord your God has been with you, and you have not lacked anything.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... My God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

2) He was aware that God had provided for Elijah during

Three and one half years of famine. You see God sent ravens twice a day with bread and meat, and provided the prophet with his own personal stream.

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... My God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

3) Paul knew that God had provided for a widow woman (This is not just a preacher thing) whose husband was dead, and her only son was about to be sold into slavery to pay her indebtedness.

Notice her desperate situation: **2 Kings 4:2** “And Elisha said unto her, What shall I do for thee? tell me, what hast thou in the house? And she said, Thine handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.”

Notice the instruction given here: **2 Kings 4:3-4** “Then he said, Go, borrow thee vessels abroad of all thy neighbours, *even* empty vessels; borrow not a few. ⁴And when thou art come in, thou shalt shut the door upon thee and upon thy sons, and shalt pour out into all those vessels, and thou shalt set aside that which is full.”

Notice what God does in response to her obedience: **2 Kings 4:5-7** “So she went from him, and shut the door upon her and upon her sons, who brought *the vessels* to her; and she poured out. ⁶And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son, Bring me yet a vessel. And he said unto her, *There is* not a vessel more. And the oil stayed. ⁷Then she came and told the man of God. And he said, Go, sell the oil, and pay thy debt, and live thou and thy children of the rest.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

4) Paul knew that God could provide a miracle for an entire city by the hands of four lepers: 2 Kings 7
(Samaria in famine, four lepers said why sit we here till we die?)

If we return to the city we will die of starvation!)

(They went into the host of the Syrians - they sounded like an army coming - they said we do not well!)

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... My God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

5) Paul knew about the miracle of the loaves and fishes: 5 loaves two fishes fed 5,000 men plus their women and children!

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... My God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

CONCLUSION: In what I will be preaching today you must understand that I am very much aware that God can find many ways to bless you outside of financial blessings.

However I am also convinced that it is the will of your Heavenly Father to bless his people with both money and possessions!

Many people believe it to be unspiritual to have wealth. But the word wealth means resources, competence to meet our obligations. Nowhere has God promised to make millionaires out of us, but he has promised to meet our every need and assures our prosperity and good success if we live according to his word! **Joshua 1:8** “Do not let this Book of the Law depart from your mouth; meditate on it day and night, so that you may be careful to do everything written in it. Then you will be prosperous and successful.”

Psalms 1:1-3 “Blessed is the man who does not walk in the counsel of the wicked or stand in the way of sinners or sit in the seat of mockers. ²But his delight is in the law of the Lord, and on his law he meditates day and night. ³He is like a tree planted by streams of water, which yields its fruit in season and whose leaf does not wither. Whatever he does prospers.”

Some people would rail on the evils of prosperity saying that the Bible speaks out on issues such as “it is more difficult for a rich man to go to Heaven than for a camel to go through the eye of a needle.” Or “the love of money is the root of all evil.” These scriptures have obviously been taken out of context!

It is the “LOVE” of money, not money itself that is the root of all evil. In the words of one of my favorite preachers, “you can love money without having it, and you can have it without loving it!”

Let me caution you, when we love money more than we love God, or we trust money more than we trust God, we get into big trouble and we miss out on God being able to bless us now, and we may miss out on heaven later! **Mark 8:34-36**

“Then he called the crowd to him along with his disciples and said: *“If anyone would come after me, he must deny himself and take up his cross and follow me. ³⁵For whoever wants to save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for me and for the gospel will save it. ³⁶What good is it for a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?”*

I personally believe that it is the will of God to prosper and bless his people. **3 John 1:2** “Beloved, I wish above all things that thou mayest prosper and be in health, even as thy soul prospereth.”

He’s my Father, of course he wants me to be blessed!

There are two things you **MUST** do in order that your life can be lived without “**LACK**”! In the sixth chapter of the book of Matthew Jesus was speaking to his disciples about material things such as food, clothing, and shelter and he says, *“But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.”*

To me, that sounds like God wants me to be blessed! However he is saying that we MUST put him and his work FIRST!

The second principle can be found in **Malachi 3:8-12** “Will a man rob God? Yet ye have robbed me. But ye say, Wherein have we robbed thee? In tithes and offerings. ⁹Ye *are* cursed with a curse: for ye have robbed me, *even* this whole nation. ¹⁰Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat in mine house, and prove me now herewith, saith the Lord of hosts, if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that *there shall not be room enough to receive it.* ¹¹And I will rebuke the devourer for your sakes, and he shall not destroy the fruits of your ground; neither shall your vine cast her fruit before the time in the field, saith the Lord of hosts. ¹²And all nations shall call you blessed: for ye shall be a delightsome land, saith the Lord of hosts.”

Now I don't want to get too deep into the curse side of this, but I do want to say that the failure to abide by the laws that God has set into motion will result in negative things happening in your life! (Lack of finances, can never seem to get ahead--- illness--- things going wrong for unexplained reasons--- etc...)

Two other thing that I want to cover before I leave this subject is laziness, and people not being good stewards with what they have. **Proverbs 23:21** “for drunkards and gluttons become poor, and drowsiness clothes them in rags.”

Once you do these things here is what you can expect; **Exodus 23:22-26** “But if thou shalt indeed obey his voice, and do all that I speak; then I will be an enemy unto thine enemies, and an adversary unto thine adversaries. ²³For mine Angel shall go before thee, and bring thee in unto the Amorites, and the Hittites, and the Perizzites, and the Canaanites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites: and I will cut them off. ²⁴Thou shalt not bow down to their gods, nor serve them, nor do after their works: but thou shalt utterly overthrow them, and quite break down their images. ²⁵And ye shall serve the Lord your God, and he shall bless thy bread, and thy water; and I will take sickness away from the midst of thee. ²⁶There shall nothing cast their young, nor be barren, in thy land: the number of thy days I will fulfil.”

Deut. 28:1-14 “If you fully obey the Lord your God and carefully follow all his commands I give you today, the Lord your God will set you high above all the nations on earth. ²All these blessings will come upon you and accompany you if you obey the Lord your God: ³ You will be blessed in the city and blessed in the country.

⁴ The fruit of your womb will be blessed, and the crops of your land and the young of your livestock--the calves of your herds and the lambs of your flocks. ⁵ Your basket and your kneading trough will be blessed. ⁶ You will be blessed when you come in and blessed when you go out. ⁷The Lord will grant that the enemies who rise up against you will be defeated before you. They will come at you from one direction but flee from you in seven. ⁸The Lord will send a blessing on your barns and on everything you put your hand to. The Lord your God will bless you in the land he is giving you. ⁹The Lord will establish you as his holy people, as he promised you on oath, if you keep the commands of the Lord your God and walk in his ways. ¹⁰Then all the peoples on earth will see that you are called by the name of the Lord, and they will fear you. ¹¹The Lord will grant you abundant prosperity--in the fruit of your womb, the young of your livestock and the crops of your ground--in the land he swore to your forefathers to give you. ¹²The Lord will open the heavens, the storehouse of his bounty, to send rain on your land in season and to bless all the work of your hands. You will lend to many nations but will borrow from none. ¹³The Lord will make you the head, not the tail. If you pay attention to the commands of the Lord your God that I give you this day and carefully follow them, you will always be at the top, never at the bottom. ¹⁴Do not turn aside from any of the commands I give you today, to the right or to the left, following other gods and serving them.”

Isaiah 30:23-26 “He will also send you rain for the seed you sow in the ground, and the food that comes from the land will be rich and plentiful. In that day your cattle will graze in broad meadows. ²⁴The oxen and donkeys that work the soil will eat fodder and mash, spread out with fork and shovel. ²⁵In the day of great slaughter, when the towers fall, streams of water will flow on every high mountain and every lofty hill. ²⁶The moon will shine like the sun, and the sunlight will be seven times brighter, like the light of seven full days, when the Lord binds up the bruises of his people and heals the wounds he inflicted.”

Deut. 8:18 “But remember the Lord your God, for it is he who gives you the ability to produce wealth, and so confirms his covenant, which he swore to your forefathers, as it is today.”

David said **“ONCE I WAS YOUNG, BUT NOW I AM OLD. I HAVE NEVER SEEN THE RIGHTEOUS FORSAKEN NOR HIS SEED BEGGING BREAD!”**

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS LACK FOR... My God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.”

III. NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR, TO DOMINATE MY LIFE, FOR... 2 Tim. 1:7 “...God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.”

A. Paul is writing his second letter to Timothy here. This letter is being written from a Roman jail cell!

This entire letter being written to Timothy is a letter of encouragement from a seasoned Pastor/Evangelist/Missionary to a young Pastor who is really just beginning his ministry.

How could someone who has given their entire life to the cause of the Gospel and ended their ministry in a jail cell encourage someone who is just beginning their ministry?

Let's look at it; **2 Tim. 1:1-2** “Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, according to the promise of life that is in Christ Jesus,
2To Timothy, my dear son: Grace, mercy and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.”

In the next two verses Paul seems to strike a cord of loneliness, **2 Tim. 1:3-4** “I thank God, whom I serve, as my forefathers did, with a clear conscience, as night and day I constantly remember you in my prayers. 3Recalling your tears, I long to see you, so that I may be filled with joy.

Paul then continues on to reminisce about the kind of stock from which Timothy was produced, **2 Tim. 1:5** “I have been reminded of your sincere faith, which first lived in your grandmother

Lois and in your mother Eunice and, I am persuaded, now lives in you also.”

Paul is saying here, That he knows for sure that Timothy is made out of good dirt! He is also saying that he expects the example that has been lived before him (through Lois, and Eunice) to be reproduced through his life! **2 Tim. 1:6**

“For this reason I remind you to fan into flame the gift of God, which is in you through the laying on of my hands.”

Paul is saying to Timothy here, “don’t allow the persecution that has come into my life, or yours, cause you to be AFRAID to let the flame of Pentecost burn in your heart. Don’t let FEAR cause you to lose your sense of urgency for the Gospel”

He is saying, “Make yourself A NEVER AGAIN LIST, and on that list determine that NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS FEAR, FOR. . . God did not give us a spirit of FEAR and timidity, but a spirit of power, of love, and of a sound mind.”

B. “FEAR” is a terrible thing! The word **“FEAR”** as it is used here comes from the Greek word **“DEILIA”** (Di-lee-ah), meaning **“TIMIDITY”**, which finds it’s expression in dread or intimidation!

Human nature is such that if we are not careful our whole world will be ruled by **“FEAR”**!

- 1) **“FEAR”** of darkness!
- 2) **“FEAR”** of crowds!
- 3) **“FEAR”** of heights!
- 4) **“FEAR”** of closed in places!
- 5) **“FEAR”** of animals”
- 6) **“FEAR”** of people!
- 7) **“FEAR”** of sickness!

It is believed that there are literally millions of **“PHOBIAS”** that control the lives of people in our world today! I suppose

this is a fulfillment of prophesy, for we are told that in the last day's "Men's hearts would fail them for **FEAR**"!

Please understand, I am very much aware that "**FEAR**" is a very real thing, and I am certainly not making light of it, but I am telling you that Paul is advising Timothy, and us not to allow "**FEAR**" to dominate our lives!

I have my mind made up that "**NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE FOR...** God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind."

How is this possible?...

C. Three things God has given us in place of "**FEAR**";

1) POWER... I suppose the first thing we must ask ourselves is "where is the **POWER** source?" **Acts 1:8** "But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth."

When a person is Baptized in the Holy Spirit, that persons spirit is infused with the "**POWER**" of God! (Jesus said the Holy Spirit is expedient for you...)

The best way that I know to describe it is when you are saved the Holy Spirit is given permission to walk alongside of you, and your life is truly different. When you receive the infilling of the Holy Spirit, your spirit becomes **TURBOCHARGED** by his Spirit!

Please be cognizant of the fact, you do not receive this kind of "**POWER**" until the Holy Spirit is allowed to fill your life, and he will not do that until he is invited to do so!

Do you want to overcome your “FEARS”? Receive the “POWER” of God!

What kind of “POWER” does God want to give us?

a) “POWER” to face trials and weaknesses and win!

Luke 10:19 “Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.”

Hebrews 11:32-40 “And what shall I more say? for the time would fail me to tell of Gedeon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthae; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets: ³³Who through faith subdued kingdoms, wrought righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions, ³⁴Quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of weakness were made strong, waxed valiant in fight, turned to flight the armies of the aliens. ³⁵Women received their dead raised to life again: and others were tortured, not accepting deliverance; that they might obtain a better resurrection: ³⁶And others had trial of *cruel* mockings and scourgings, yea, moreover of bonds and imprisonment: ³⁷They were stoned, they were sawn asunder, were tempted, were slain with the sword: they wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins; being destitute, afflicted, tormented; ³⁸(Of whom the world was not worthy:) they wandered in deserts, and *in* mountains, and *in* dens and caves of the earth. ³⁹And these all, having obtained a good report through faith, received not the promise: ⁴⁰God having provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE FOR... God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.”

b) “POWER” to be a proper example! **2 Cor. 3:2-6**

“You yourselves are our letter, written on our hearts, known and read by everybody. ³You show that you are a letter from Christ, the result of our ministry, written not with ink but with the Spirit of the living God, not on tablets of stone but on tablets of human hearts. ⁴Such confidence as this is ours through Christ before God. ⁵Not that we are competent in ourselves to claim anything for ourselves, but our competence comes from God. ⁶He has made us competent as ministers of a new

covenant--not of the letter but of the Spirit; for the letter kills, but the Spirit gives life.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE FOR... God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.”

c) **“POWER”** to witness! **Acts 4:33** “And with great power gave the apostles witness of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus: and great grace was upon them all.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE FOR... God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.”

d) **“POWER”** to do a job, and do it well! **2 Cor. 9:8**
“And God is able to make all grace abound to you, so that in all things at all times, having all that you need, you will abound in every good work.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE, FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME POWER TO OVERCOME ALL FEAR!”

2) LOVE... Now what does **“LOVE”** have to do with **“FEAR”**? The Bible say’s that **“perfect LOVE casteth out all FEAR”**!

Again, the believers spirit is infused with **“LOVE”**, not just any **“LOVE”**, but **“AGAPE LOVE”**!

The difference between human **“LOVE”**, and **“AGAPE LOVE”** is, that human **“LOVE”** is contingent upon someone reciprocating those feelings or acts of kindness, and **“AGAPE LOVE”** will act, even if it is a one way or dead end street!

The reason that **“AGAPE LOVE”** is so different from human

“LOVE” is because human **“LOVE”** is an emotion, and **“AGAPE LOVE”** is an act of the will!

“AGAPE LOVE”;

a) LOVES people who do not deserve it! **Romans 5:8**

“But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.”

Luke 6:27-35 “But I say unto you which hear, Love your enemies, do good to them which hate you, ²⁸Bless them that curse you, and pray for them which despitefully use you. ²⁹And unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other; and him that taketh away thy cloke forbid not to take thy coat also. ³⁰Give to every man that asketh of thee; and of him that taketh away thy goods ask them not again. ³¹And as ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise. ³²For if ye love them which love you, what thank have ye? for sinners also love those that love them. ³³And if ye do good to them which do good to you, what thank have ye? for sinners also do even the same. ³⁴And if ye lend to them of whom ye hope to receive, what thank have ye? for sinners also lend to sinners, to receive as much again. ³⁵But love ye your enemies, and do good, and lend, hoping for nothing again; and your reward shall be great, and ye shall be the children of the Highest: for he is kind unto the unthankful and to the evil.”

Many times we allow ourselves to be **“INTIMIDATED”** about **“LOVING”** someone, or expressing our **“LOVE”** to a person that we do not see as deserving or worthy of our **“LOVE”**!

Never forget that you and I were certainly not worthy or deserving of the **“LOVE”** that God shed abroad in our hearts!

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE, FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME A LOVE THAT

OVERCOMES ALL FEAR!”

b) knows no boundaries! Human “**LOVE**” demands to be reciprocated! (I will **LOVE** you if you will **LOVE** me!) Someone described this as puppy **LOVE**, but don’t forget that puppy **LOVE** often turns into a dog’s life!)

This is an extremely selfish kind of “**LOVE**” because it does not necessarily seek to serve, but seeks to be served. This kind of love does not perform random acts of kindness, but performs certain favors expecting a positive response, and something in return!

“**AGAPE LOVE**”, will go on “**LOVING**” if it is never reciprocated! **John 3:16-17** “For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. ¹⁷For God sent not his Son into the world to condemn the world; but that the world through him might be saved.”

John 13:34-35 “A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another. ³⁵By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples, if ye have love one to another.”

“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE, FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME A LOVE THAT OVERCOMES ALL FEAR!

c) Cast’s out all “**FEAR**”! **1 John 4:16-21** “And we have known and believed the love that God hath to us. God is love; and he that dwelleth in love dwelleth in God, and God in him. ¹⁷Herein is our love made perfect, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment: because as he is, so are we in this world. ¹⁸There is no fear in love; but perfect love casteth out fear: because fear hath torment. He that feareth is not made perfect in love. ¹⁹We love him, because he first loved us. ²⁰If a man say, I love God,

and hateth his brother, he is a liar: for he that loveth not his brother whom he hath seen, how can he love God whom he hath not seen? ²¹And this commandment have we from him, That he who loveth God love his brother also.”

According to this Scripture, if you are walking in the perfect **“LOVE”** of God you will not allow your life to be driven by **“FEAR”**!

Do you remember our definition that I gave regarding **“FEAR”** when I first began this message? The word **“FEAR”** as it is used here comes from the Greek word **“DEILIA”** (Di-lee-ah), meaning **“TIMIDITY”**, which finds its expression in dread or intimidation!

People who are driven by **“FEAR”**, have all sorts of petty jealousies! (Companion, possessions, friendships, sibling rivalries, employment advancement, religious recognition, etc...)

If you are being ruled by all sorts of petty jealousies, let me tell you that your life will be miserable, and you will create what you are trying to prevent! **Song 8:6-7** “Set me as a seal upon thine heart, as a seal upon thine arm: for love *is* strong as death; jealousy is cruel as the grave: the coals thereof are coals of fire, which hath a most vehement flame. ⁷Many waters cannot quench love, neither can the floods drown it: if *a* man would give all the substance of his house for love, it would utterly be contemned.”

Jealousy is really **“FEAR”** wrapped under a very thin disguise. If you are allowing yourself to be intimidated by another person, or by the enemy, you are being controlled by **“FEAR”**! Either way, the quality of your life and the lives of those around you will be sadly diminished! Is that what you really want for you and your family?

How do you overcome this kind of **“FEAR”**? Let **“AGAPE**

LOVE” rule your life for “PERFECT LOVE CASTETH OUT ALL FEAR!”

Make yourself a **“NEVER AGAIN LIST”**, and determine within yourself that **“NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE, FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME A LOVE THAT CASTS OUT ALL FEAR!”** (Example of picking someone up by the nap of the neck and the seat of the britches...)

(SONG; LOVE LIFTED ME)

3) A SOUND MIND... I suppose my first reaction here would be one of confusion, because it is very difficult to imagine what **“A SOUND MIND”** has to do with **“FEAR”!**

The words, **“SOUND MIND”** comes from the Greek word, **“SOPHRONISMOS”** (so-fron-is-mos’), meaning disciplined, or self controlled.

Think about this, when **“FEAR”** begins to grip our life the first thing the enemy will attempt to do is put your **“MIND”** on a run-a-way train! All kinds of thoughts will come into your mind;

a) Your child is late coming home: The first places you check is the hospitals and police stations! That’s not Faith, that’s **“FEAR”!**

b) Your spouse is late coming home from work: The first thing you do is to accuse them of having an affair! That’s not Faith, that’s **“FEAR”!**

c) Your employer wants to talk to you: Immediately you jump to the conclusion that you are going to be laid off! That’s not Faith that’s **“FEAR”!**

d) Your child needs a few minutes of your time to talk to you

about something important: Immediately you jump to the conclusion (That is how some people get their exercise, jumping to conclusions!) that they are going to tell you that they are going to have an illegitimate child! (In my opinion there is no such thing as an illegitimate child, but I have been around several illegitimate parents!) That's not Faith, that's **"FEAR"**!

e) The Pastor goes on vacation, and you automatically assume he has gone to candidate for another Church! (Promises, promises, promises... Bro. Branson, lady who said the devil told me you went to try out for another Church... That wasn't the devil!) That's not Faith, that's **"FEAR"**!

f) The Doctor want's to run some tests, you just know you are going to be diagnosed with a terminal illness! That's not Faith, that's **"FEAR"**!

g) The check engine light comes on, your car just needs a tune up, and you assume the engine has gone bad! That's not Faith, that's **"FEAR"**!

NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME A SOUND MIND TO FIGHT THE DEVIL WITH!

See, the world's biggest battle ground is in our minds! Here is where the battle is won or lost! **NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO RULE MY LIFE, FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME A SOUND MIND TO FIGHT THE DEVIL WITH!**

LEGION - **Mark 5:15** "And they come to Jesus, and see him that was possessed with the devil, and had the legion, sitting, and clothed, and in his right mind: and they were afraid."

Prodigal Son - **Luke 15:17** "And when he came to

himself, he said, How many hired servants of my father's have bread enough and to spare, and I perish with hunger!"

Proverbs 12:5 "The thoughts of the righteous are right; *but* the counsels of the wicked *are* deceit."

How could that be? **Philip. 2:5** "Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus:"

2 Cor. 10:4-5 "For the weapons of our warfare *are* not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds; ^sCasting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ;"

Here is how it works the Holy Spirit infuses our "MINDS" with the ability to control our emotions, feelings, and thoughts in the best and worst of times!

To allow Christ to have the mastery over your "MIND", is to guarantee yourself of a victorious life! To allow "FEAR" to rule your mind, is to guarantee disaster!

Romans 8:5-7 "For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh; but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit. For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace. ⁷Because the carnal mind is enmity against God: for it is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be."

1 Peter 1:13 "... gird up the loins of your mind, be sober, and hope to the end for the grace that is to be brought unto you at the revelation of Jesus Christ;"

NEVER AGAIN WILL I ALLOW FEAR TO DOMINATE MY LIFE FOR GOD HAS GIVEN ME POWER TO CONQUER FEAR, LOVE TO OVERCOME FEAR, AND A SOUND MIND TO OUT THINK FEAR!!!

IV. NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR GOD HAS SAID... 1 John 4:4 “Ye are of God, little children, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in you, than he that is in the world.”

A. The writer of the book of First John is the Apostle John. He does not seem to write to any group in particular, but to the Church at large.

The Apostle John seems to have four primary reasons for writing this letter;

- 1) To add to the joy of those who are a part of the Church!
- 2) To emphasize the need to guard against sin!
- 3) To warn the Church of the danger of false teachers!
- 4) To teach the Church how to strengthen it's faith in Christ, and to give assurance not only of abundant life, but of eternal life!

Notice with me once again the verse we have targeted for examination today... **1 John 4:4** “Ye are of God, little children, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in you, than he that is in the world.”

Notice first of all, that the writer say's “**YOU ARE OF GOD, LITTLE CHILDREN...**” Please understand these first Six words of verse Four, though often overlooked, may very well be the most significant words of the entire book!

Sure, we are “**LITTLE CHILDREN**” in God! Most of us read that and would focus on the helplessness of a “**LITTLE CHILD**”.

But remember, a “**LITTLE CHILD**” has the backing, support, and resources of it's parents behind it!

I am my Father's son, and so are you! Because we are his

“CHILDREN”, we have;

- 1) His blood!
- 2) His personality!
- 3) His nature!
- 4) His power!

No wonder the Apostle John went on to say, **“... AND HAVE OVERCOME THEM”**. Who is John speaking of when he uses the word **“THEM”** here?

He has just gone to great length to talk about the spirits that are at work in the world today! The spirits of false prophets, Spirits that refuse to confess Jesus Christ as lord, and the spirit of antichrist!

Here is what blesses my socks off! He then hastens on to say, that **“LITTLE CHILDREN”** in the kingdom will have no problem overcoming every spirit that is in the world!”

That being true, why would any of us who are saved ever **“CONFESS SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER OUR LIVES?”**

How is it that the Apostle John can guarantee that **“LITTLE CHILDREN”** in the kingdom can **“OVERCOME”** the biggest baddest spirits that are in operation in this present world?

2 Cor. 10:3-5 “For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh: ⁴(For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;) ⁵Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ;”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that

is in the world.

**B. I know that most of us would never admit that we confess
“SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER OUR LIVES”!**

However, on many occasions we have done just that! We have confessed defeat, sickness, poverty, spiritual lack, destruction of relationships, and so many other confessions of inferiority that I do not have time to go into all of them!

Suffice it to say, that as a **“CHILD”** of God, you are not inferior to any spirit that is in operation in this world today! You are not inferior to the devil, demons, imps, or any other force that he could drag up out of hell! Not only are you not inferior, but you are superior, not in yourself, but through Christ!

Notice John say’s “... Greater is he that is in you,
than he that is in the world.”

**NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY
OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR...** I am a little child of God,
and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that
is in the world.

C. Two things that I want to look very closely at;

1) Satan is limited!

2) We are victorious!

1) SATAN IS LIMITED! Satan is not omnipotent,
omnipresent, or omniscient!

Satan knows his **“LIMITATIONS”** much better than we do.
Basically Satan is running a bluff on the **“CHILDREN”** of
God!

SATAN IS LIMITED IN HIS AFFLICTION OF THE SAINTS! Regarding Satans affliction of Job the scripture say's **Job 1:12** "And the Lord said unto Satan, Behold, all that he hath is in thy power; only upon himself put not forth thine hand. So Satan went forth from the presence of the Lord."

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

SATAN IS LIMITED IN HIS TEMPTATION OF THE CHILDREN OF GOD! 1 Cor. 10:13 "There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it."

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

SATAN IS LIMITED IN HOW MUCH POWER HE WIELDS OVER THE CHILDREN OF GOD!

Luke 10:19 "Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you."

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

2) WE ARE VICTORIOUS! Luke 22:31-32 "And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat: ³²But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and when thou art converted, strengthen thy

brethren.”

How could you be less than “**VICTORIOUS**” with Jesus the Son of God praying for you on a continual basis?

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

How thorough is this “**VICTORY**” that Christ has promised to us? **Isaiah 54:17** “No weapon that is formed against thee shall prosper; and every tongue that shall rise against thee in judgment thou shalt condemn. This is the heritage of the servants of the Lord, and their righteousness is of me, saith the Lord.”

Luke 10:19 “Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

When will this “**VICTORY**” be forthcoming in your life?

Romans 16:20 “And the God of peace shall bruise Satan under your feet shortly.”

Satan is hamstrung because of his limitations!

Look at what is promised to all who are “**VICTORIOUS**” over the enemy;

1) Spiritual food! **Rev. 2:7** “He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life, which is in the midst of the

paradise of God.”

Rev. 2:17 “He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, ...”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

2) A new name! **Rev. 2:17** “He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it.”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

3) Authority! **Rev. 2:26** “And he that overcometh, and keepeth my works unto the end, to him will I give power (Authority) over the nations:”

2 Tim. 2:11-12 “*It is a faithful saying: For if we be dead with him, we shall also live with him:* ¹²If we suffer, we shall also reign with him...”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

4) Robes of righteousness! **Rev. 3:5** “He that overcometh, the same shall be clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of

life, but I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels.”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

5) Enthronement! **Rev. 3:21** “To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with me in my throne, even as I also overcame, and am set down with my Father in his throne.”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

6) An eternal inheritance! **Rev. 21:7** “He that overcometh shall inherit all things; and I will be his God, and he shall be my son.”

NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS THE SUPREMACY OF SATAN OVER MY LIFE FOR... I am a little child of God, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in me, than he that is in the world.

V. NEVER AGAIN WILL I CONFESS SICKNESS, FOR...

“He *was* wounded for my transgressions, *he was* bruised for my iniquities: the chastisement of my peace *was* upon him; and with his stripes I am healed.”

A. Many people who say they believe in “**DIVINE HEALING**” spend an exorbitant amount of their time confessing “**SICKNESS**” and “**DISEASE**” over their lives.

Many people will tell you right up front that they have been “**TRYING**” to catch a cold, or some other malady.

The message of **“DIVINE HEALING”** has been all but lost out of the Pentecostal church!

Some of the reason for this is that many preachers do not want anyone to think they are a part of the **“NAME IT AND CLAIM IT”** or **“BLAB IT AND GRAB IT”** crowd! As a result, they and their congregations have become a part of the **“DOUBT IT AND DO WITHOUT IT”** crowd!

This kind of philosophy will produce a church full of **“SICK”** people!

Now let me just tell you that if you are bent on being **“SICK”**, don't let me stand in your way, help yourself! If it were not for **“SICKNESS”** some people could not even carry on a conversation!

I have actually prayed for people who I knew full well that they did not want to be **“HEALED”**! They were getting too much mileage out of their **“SICKNESS”** to let it go! (Story of the man who did not want to be prayed for because he was on full disability!)

However if you have better things to do than sit in the doctors office by the hour, I am going to attempt to tell you how to walk in your **“HEALING”**!

First of all you are going to have to make up your mind to quit talking yourself into being **“SICK”**!

It is easier to speak **“HEALING”**, than to go to the trouble of staying **“SICK”**! Can I tell you, your Heavenly Father want's you to be well!

Under the Old Testament economy the promises regarding the **“HEALTH”** of the Children of God is very plainly described as

being protected by God! **Psalm 91:9-16** “Because thou hast made the Lord, *which is* my refuge, *even* the most High, thy habitation; ¹⁰There shall no evil befall thee, neither shall any plague come nigh thy dwelling. ¹¹For he shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee in all thy ways. ¹²They shall bear thee up in *their* hands, lest thou dash thy foot against a stone. ¹³Thou shalt tread upon the lion and adder: the young lion and the dragon shalt thou trample under feet. ¹⁴Because he hath set his love upon me, therefore will I deliver him: I will set him on high, because he hath known my name. ¹⁵He shall call upon me, and I will answer him: I *will be* with him in trouble; I will deliver him, and honour him. ¹⁶With long life will I satisfy him, and shew him my salvation.”

I’m not sure we really understand this! Under the Old Testament economy God makes promises to his people such as, **“NO PLAGUE SHALL COME NIGH THY DWELLING”,** and **“WITH LONG LIFE I WILL SATISFY YOU”!**

Notice our text: **Isaiah 53:5** “But he *was* wounded for our transgressions, *he was* bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace *was* upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.”

The writer of the book of Hebrews said that under the dispensation of Grace, God has given us;

“BETTER” things!
“BETTER” hope!
“BETTER” testament!
“BETTER” covenant!
“BETTER” sacrifices!
“BETTER” substance!
“BETTER” country!
“BETTER” resurrection!
“BETTER” inheritance!
“BETTER” promises!

Now, if God promised those people under the Old Testament economy that **“NO PLAGUE WOULD COME NIGH THEIR DWELLING”,** and that he would **“SATISFY THEM**

WITH LONG LIFE”, and we have **“BETTER PROMISES”** under the New Testament economy, then we should claim the **“PROMISES”** and walk in our **“HEALING”!** Notice this: **1 Peter 2:24** “Who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree, that we, being dead to sins, should live unto righteousness: by whose stripes ye were healed.”

Isaiah 53:5 “But he *was* wounded for our transgressions, *he was* bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace *was* upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.”

Exodus 15:26 “And said, If thou wilt diligently hearken to the voice of the Lord thy God, and wilt do that which is right in his sight, and wilt give ear to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of these diseases upon thee, which I have brought upon the Egyptians: for I am the Lord that healeth thee.”

Please notice what the Word of God is saying with regard to **“HEALING”**. It say’s we **“WERE HEALED”**, we **“ARE HEALED”**, and we are **“BEING HEALED”!** My friend that is past, present, and future tense!

Based on those Scriptures, I would say God has us covered on the subject of **“DIVINE HEALING”!**

I want us to sing the old song, **“STANDING ON THE PROMISES”!**

B. I want us to spend some time exploring what the Word of God has to say about what we are to do in order that we could receive our **“HEALING”!**

1) Confess your faults! **James 5:16** “Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much.”

We are being told here that if we want to be **“HEALED”** we must acknowledge our sinful condition!

Notice what he say's will happen to the person who will suppress pride and confess his sin: **James 5:16** "Confess *your* faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much.

"HEALING" is **"PROMISED"** to those who acknowledge and forsake a sinful condition!

He then say's, "... The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much." This simply means **"The producing, valid, intensely earnest prayer of righteous people will get the job done!"**

Some times we do not feel very **"RIGHTEOUS"**, thus we have very little confidence in our own ability to pray, or receive from God!

Let me just tell you that if you have confessed your sin's to God, you are as **"RIGHTEOUS"** as the blood of Jesus can make you! You and I are certainly not worthy on our own merits, but we have been made worthy by the blood of Jesus! If we are as worthy to receive our **"HEALING"** as the blood of Jesus can make us we might as well lay hold of the promise and receive our **"HEALING"** today!

There's an old song entitled **"THE HEALER"** that has a powerful message on the subject of **"HEALING"** and I want us to pay attention to it's message:

On the cross crucified, in great sorrow he died:
The giver of life was he.
Yet my Lord was despised and rejected of men,
this Jesus of Calvary.

Price for healing was paid, as those cruel stripes were made,

within Pilates judgment hall.
Now his suffering affords perfect healing for all.
This wonderful healer's mine.

Came the leper to Christ, saying surely I know,
that thou, Lord, can's't make me whole.
When his great faith was seen Jesus said "yes, I will".
And touched him and made him clean.

He has healed my sick soul, made me ever whit whole,
and he'll do the same for you.
He's the same yesterday and today and for aye.
This healer of men today.

He was wounded for our transgressions,
he was bruised for our iniquities;
surely he bore our sorrows,
and by his stripes we are healed.

2) Lay hands on the "SICK"! **James 5:14** "Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord:"

Notice with me there are several things that are to happen here;
a) The sick are to "CALL FOR THE ELDERS OF THE CHURCH"! No where in your Bible are the elders instructed to call on the "SICK"! Those who are "SICK" are to do the calling!

b) The elders are instructed to;
Anoint you with oil...
Lay hands on you...
Pray over you...

They are to do all of this in the name of the Lord!

Notice verse 15 “And the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up; and if he have committed sins, they shall be forgiven him.”

C. Some of the “**SICKNESSES**” and “**DISEASES**” that were “**HEALED**” in the Bible include;

- 1) Blindness
- 2) Boils
- 3) Deafness
- 4) Dropsy
- 5) Dysentery
- 6) Epilepsy
- 7) Fever
- 8) Hemorrhoids
- 9) Insanity
- 10) Issue of blood
- 11) Lameness
- 12) Leprosy
- 13) Palsy
- 14) Snake Bite
- 15) Sun Stroke

I want to go on record right now as saying that God has never seen a disease he could not “**HEAL**”!!!

If he was God enough to “**HEAL**” in the Old Testament and the New Testament, he is God enough to “**HEAL**” right now!

Hebrews 13:8 “Jesus Christ the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever.”

I want you to know that God is not only able to “**HEAL**” you, but he is also willing to “**HEAL**” you!

